

Locked Interview Story

Tell me about the project -- 60-second stammer-friendly script

Project: logistics-rag-agent

How to use: Speak one numbered line. Stop. Breathe 2 seconds. Next line.

If you stick: restart that one line only. Do not apologize -- pause and continue.

Locked choices

- Purpose: DeCA-style work piles alerts, PDFs, and math -- one trusted assistant.
- Why me: Real DoD commissary inventory / supply experience.
- Demo: Phantom flour -- system 48, shelf 0.
- Data: Synthetic DeCA-style docs; real ops pain; same pattern on real SOPs.
- Length: ~60 seconds (8 short lines).
- Outcome: Faster morning decisions. Safer orders. Answers I can cite.

Purpose line (say once if asked why)

"I built it because DeCA-style work piles alerts, PDFs, and math at once -- I wanted one trusted assistant for that morning rush."

Data honesty (if asked about real DeCA data)

"The docs are synthetic, DeCA-style. The pain is real from commissary work. The agent pattern is what I would run on real SOPs."

60-second open (memorize this)

Say each line. [BREATHE] = silent 2-count. Then stop and wait.

- 1. I built a logistics ops agent for DeCA-style inventory work. [BREATHE]
- 2. I worked inventory and supply at a DoD commissary. [BREATHE]
- 3. I felt that morning alert rush myself. [BREATHE]
- 4. Alerts, PDFs, and math piled up at once. [BREATHE]
- 5. So I built one trusted assistant for that rush. [BREATHE]
- 6. Tools do the numbers. RAG searches the SOPs. [BREATHE]
- 7. Example: flour looks like 48 in the system -- shelf is empty. [BREATHE]
- 8. Outcome: faster morning decisions. Safer orders. Answers I can cite. [BREATHE]

If they want more: "Happy to walk the flour morning next."

Origin arc (5 words)

- Why me -- commissary inventory / supply; felt the morning rush.
- Problem -- alerts + PDFs + math piled up; people guessed.
- Build -- tools for numbers, RAG for SOPs, no invented facts.
- Demo -- phantom flour (system 48, shelf empty).
- Outcome -- faster decisions, safer orders, citable answers.

Follow-up demo -- phantom flour

Use only if they ask for a walkthrough.

- 1. Morning NIS report: flour Item 10045. System 48. Shelf 0. [BREATHE]
- 2. That is phantom inventory -- BoH must be fixed. [BREATHE]
- 3. Nancy asks the agent in English. [BREATHE]
- 4. Doc search finds planogram, NIS rules, maybe recall. [BREATHE]
- 5. Tools handle EOQ or safety stock if she asks how much. [BREATHE]
- 6. Agent does not invent facts. Thin docs -> "I don't know." [BREATHE]
- 7. She corrects BoH and writes a safer next step -- with a cite. [BREATHE]

Soft landing phrases

- "One second -- I'll restart that line."
- "Short version: ..."
- "The key point is ..."
- "Next beat: ..."

Tech cheat sheet (short answers)

If they ask: Stack?

You say: Python. LangChain agent. Ollama LLM. Chroma. Local embeddings.

If they ask: Models?

You say: Chat: llama3.1:8b. Embed: nomic-embed-text.

If they ask: Tools?

You say: Inventory lookup. EOQ. Safety stock. Doc search.

If they ask: EOQ formula?

You say: Square root of two D S over H.

If they ask: Safety stock?

You say: Z times demand std times square root of lead time.

If they ask: Grounding?

You say: Answer only from retrieved chunks. Else: "I don't know".

If they ask: Ingest?

You say: PDFs -> chunk -> embed -> Chroma. Safe re-run skips old files.

If they ask: Why local?

You say: Ops data stays local. Cost control. Works offline-ish.

If they ask: Real DeCA data?

You say: Synthetic DeCA-style docs. Real commissary pain. Same pattern on real SOPs.

If they ask: Why this project?

You say: Morning rush: alerts + PDFs + math. One trusted assistant.

Practice checklist

- Read the 8 open lines out loud once (with breaths).
- Practice the flour walkthrough only as a follow-up.
- Keep follow-up answers under 45 seconds.
- Source markdown: docs/deca-interview-cue-card.md